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WAM

MOHAMMED PRESENTS QURAN AWARD

■ His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, on Tuesday honoured the winners of the Most Beautiful Quran Recitation for 2026 that forms part of the 28th edition of the Dubai International Holy Quran Award. Sheikh Mohammed honoured the winners during a reception for the Award's finalists held at Majlis Umm Suqeim, where he praised their excellence in recitation and their commitment to the Holy Quran.

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RESOLUTE UAE STAYS STEADY AMID REGIONAL TURMOIL

Malls, parks full; more flights take off

DUBAI

BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter
ANUPAM VARMA
News & Business Editor

Shopping malls and parks are crowded, planes are taking off and landing, ports are operating as usual, and banking services are up without a glitch.

With careful assessment, timely intervention and an abundance of caution, the UAE has once again demonstrated what good leadership can achieve. Earlier this week, President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan and Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council, were seen together in a shopping mall in Dubai, greeting people. A day later, senior government ministers went live on TV and assured everyone that the country was in safe hands.

Operation of flights

Perhaps the most evident reassurance for residents was the operation of flights. When Abdulla Bin Touq Al Marri, Minister of Economy and Tourism, said during a government media briefing on Tuesday that a total of 17,498 passengers had travelled on 60 flights between March 1 and 3, it showed the magnitude of labour airport officials, airlines and concerned

BUSINESS LEADERS HAIL UAE'S RESILIENCE



SEE P8-9

government authorities had put in to get things back in order. Several thousand more passengers travelled to their destinations yesterday.

Ports holding firm

At Jebel Ali Port, the Middle East's largest maritime hub, ships were sailing in and out as usual. DP World confirmed yesterday that operations are continuing without disruption, a remarkable turnaround from Sunday, March 1, when debris from an aerial interception ignited a fire at the facility. By the end of that same day, all four terminals were back to full capacity after a brief precautionary pause. AD Ports Group echoed the same message, confirming that all ports and terminals it manages across the UAE

remain fully operational, along with associated services.

Even at the Fujairah Oil Industry Zone (FOIZ), where a fire broke out after drone debris landed on Tuesday morning, Gulf Navigation Holding confirmed that all petroleum storage facilities and tanker fleets are running normally.

Banks and telecoms

In Dubai, flagship developer Emaar confirmed that all its communities, malls, hospitality assets and development projects continue to operate as usual. Mohamed Alabbar, the company's founder, offered perhaps the sharpest summary of where the UAE stands right now. "The city continues to demonstrate resilience, supported by effective leadership, sound regulation, and a dynamic business environment. Our focus remains on disciplined execution, operational excellence, and delivering sustainable value for our shareholders and customers," he said.

Banks such as Abu Dhabi Commercial Bank (ADCB), which reported temporary technical issues affecting some online platforms, confirmed restoration of all services. Telecom operator du added that mobile, fixed and enterprise networks remain fully operational.

Medicine stocks secure

Meanwhile, the government assured the residents that the country's strategic stockpile of medicines and medical supplies is secure and sufficient to meet the needs of the local market.



IFTAR 18:26

Fajr	05:21	Shuruq	06:34
Dhuhr	12:33	Asr	15:53
Maghrib	18:26	Isha	19:40

IMSAK 05:11

Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah



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THE VIEWS

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SPORT

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Co-hosts take on
confident England
in 2nd semis | P11

US is 'winning' the war against Iran, Hegseth says

US submarine sinks Iranian warship, 87 bodies recovered

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

US Defence Secretary Pete Hegseth said Washington's military campaign against Iran was accelerating, declaring the United States was winning the war "decisively, devastatingly and without mercy" as more American forces moved into the region.

Hegseth said additional fighter jets and bombers would soon arrive in the Middle East and that US operations would continue as long as necessary. "We will take all the time we need to make sure that we succeed," he said.

Hegseth also confirmed that a US submarine torpedoed and sank an Iranian warship in the Indian Ocean on Tuesday night, marking the first time since World War II that a submarine has destroyed an enemy warship in combat.

Sri Lankan authorities said 32 sailors were rescued from

the vessel while 87 bodies have been recovered and dozens remain missing after the ship sank off the island's southern coast.

Explosions reported

Earlier, explosions were reported across Tehran as the war between Iran, the United States and Israel entered its fifth day.

On Tuesday, US President Donald Trump said Iran's military capabilities had been severely weakened after days of joint US-Israeli strikes but warned the outcome of the conflict remained uncertain, saying the worst scenario would be if a new Iranian leader emerged who was "as bad as the previous one."

The conflict is widening across the region. Israel launched fresh strikes on Tehran and other Iranian cities while Iran fired missiles and drones toward Israel and US-linked targets.

Turkey also warned Tehran after Nato air-defence systems intercepted a ballistic missile launched from Iran before it entered Turkish airspace.

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